my secretary in November 2009). I was pleasantly surprised when an elderly 'gaon bura' approached me and said, 'Sir, I worked with you during your battalion's operation in this area in 1981.' At Tirap I gave a clear message to the security forces, the civil administration and the citizens that law and order will be given the highest priority, and insurgency would not be tolerated. A strong message went across that the governor had accorded prime importance to this issue, and had made sure that his first visit was to this disturbed area. In accordance with the aforementioned special responsibility, I analysed the overall security situation and recommended measures for enhancing the effectiveness of the law and order machinery. At that time, Tirap and Changlang districts were witnessing violence and strife and a vicious struggle for dominance by the two NSCN groups. Forced recruitment, illegal taxation, extortion and coercion were the order of the day. The state police and other security forces were unable to take effective action against these terrorist outfits because of inadequate strength, lack of modern weapons and training. Thus, the modernization, expansion and training of the police and beefing up of force levels in these districts became a priority for us.

The need for a cohesive strategy and coordinated actions of various agencies responsible for combating terrorism in the two affected districts and other areas bordering Assam, where the Bodo or the ULFA terrorists often seek refuge, also emerged clearly. Therefore, I recommended the creation of an apex body – a state-level core group on security with the chief minister as the chairperson with high-ranking representatives of the army, police, paramilitary forces alongwith the chief secretary and other civilian officials as members. As usual, initially we faced resistance from the bureaucracy in Delhi, but eventually, we were able to convince them of our rationale, and this set-up was created. In one of their meetings, important guidelines were conveyed by me to this group. 'First and foremost an overall security aim should be evolved which would ensure law and order prevails throughout the state and that no terrorist group is allowed to establish its roots or dominance in any part of Arunachal Pradesh. To achieve this aim, a strategy must